

PUSHKAR AWATE

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[Portfolio](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#)

AI & ML Engineer • Python, AWS & Kubernetes • MLOps, Orchestration & Deployment • Agentic AI (Claude Code)

SUMMARY

AI and Machine Learning Engineer with a Master of Artificial Intelligence and two years of production infrastructure experience. I build and ship end-to-end AI and ML systems: training and tuning models, orchestrating version-controlled pipelines, and deploying and running them on cloud and Kubernetes. My most recent work is an XGBoost geospatial classification pipeline built inside an agentic, AI-agent-driven workflow.

SKILLS

Languages	Python, Java, C++, SQL, NoSQL (DynamoDB)
Cloud & Infra	AWS (EC2, ECS Fargate, Lambda, S3, SageMaker), Flask, Docker, Kubernetes (AKS, GKE), CI/CD, Git, ServiceNow
AI & Orchestration	AI coding agent (Claude Code), agentic workflows, pipeline orchestration (Kestra), Optuna, hyperparameter tuning
Geospatial & Stats	GeoPandas, QGIS, LOCO cross-validation
Machine Learning	XGBoost, TensorFlow, Scikit-learn
Monitoring & Evaluation	Model drift / OOD detection, macro-F1, error analysis, observability (Dynatrace)

EXPERIENCE

Prodegee (via RMIT), Melbourne, Australia Feb 2026 - Jun 2026

AI/ML Engineering Intern

- Lifted model F1 from 0.8722 to 0.8858 across an 8-country geospatial corpus by building an XGBoost classifier and running 100 Optuna hyperparameter-tuning trials.
- Selected the strongest production model by benchmarking XGBoost, Random Forest and Logistic Regression across 200 surveyed villages, then testing generalization on 35 villages with no survey data.
- Restored a key feature-target correlation from -0.714 to +0.600 by tracking down and fixing a feature-collapse bug that was quietly degrading model quality.
- Enabled trusted blind inference on 2,996 unsurveyed villages by building an out-of-distribution flagging system that gated low-confidence predictions.
- Delivered production-ready JSON artifacts, validated in QGIS and consumed by two downstream teams, by running every task through a peer-reviewed GitHub kanban workflow with Kestra orchestration (AI coding agent: Claude Code).

Atos-Syntel Sep 2021 - Jun 2023

Associate Consultant (Kubernetes Architect)

- Kept production Kubernetes clusters current and stable for a US-based client, as part of a seven-engineer team, by planning and running regular upgrade cycles without breaking running workloads.
- Sustained high availability on critical services (Pods, Ingress) by troubleshooting incidents under time pressure, digging through logs and cluster events to find root causes.
- Caught problems before they became incidents by continuously monitoring cluster health in Dynatrace, and managed incident and change workflows in ServiceNow.
- Optimized cost and headroom by scaling node pools to workload demand and renewing TLS certificates on schedule.
- Built deep working knowledge of core Kubernetes internals (Ingress, kube-scheduler, kube-controller-manager, kube-proxy), which sped up root-cause diagnosis when services failed.

PROJECTS

- Music Subscription App** Deployed one Flask music service three ways (EC2, ECS Fargate and Lambda), each backed by DynamoDB and S3 and containerized with Docker, to compare cost, latency and operational overhead across VM, managed-container and serverless approaches | github.com/pushkar-awate/music-subscription-app
- Visual Entailment (Vision + Text)** Multimodal model fusing an EfficientNetB0 vision encoder and a BiLSTM text branch via cross-modal attention; 73.2% accuracy on ~39k noisy image-text pairs; trained on AWS SageMaker, with macro-F1 and error analysis driving iteration. (RMIT, 2025)
- Healthcare Management System** JavaFX MVC desktop application with JPA/Hibernate persistence and JUnit test coverage, built to demonstrate clean software-engineering fundamentals outside an ML context | github.com/pushkar-awate/healthcare-javafx-assignment
- Interactive Mirror (Voice Assistance)** Voice-controlled smart mirror on Raspberry Pi combining a two-way mirror, a display and voice-assistant integration; published academically in IRJET Vol. 8, Issue 4 (Sr. No. 330) | irjet.net/volume8-issue04

EDUCATION

RMIT University, Melbourne, Australia

2024 - 2026

Master of Artificial Intelligence

Relevant coursework: Computational ML, Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning, Cloud Computing, Intelligent Decision Making

Pune University, India

2018 - 2021

Bachelor of Information Technology

CGPA: 7.78 / 10